

PAULT DOCUMENTATION

User Guide

Clean Technical edition for the current macOS app implementation.

Main Window	Menu Bar	Hotkey Launcher	Template Variables
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Scope: This guide reflects the app behavior currently implemented in this repository, including template-variable parsing and resolved copy/paste flows.

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Guide Map

Use this map to jump directly to the workflow you need.

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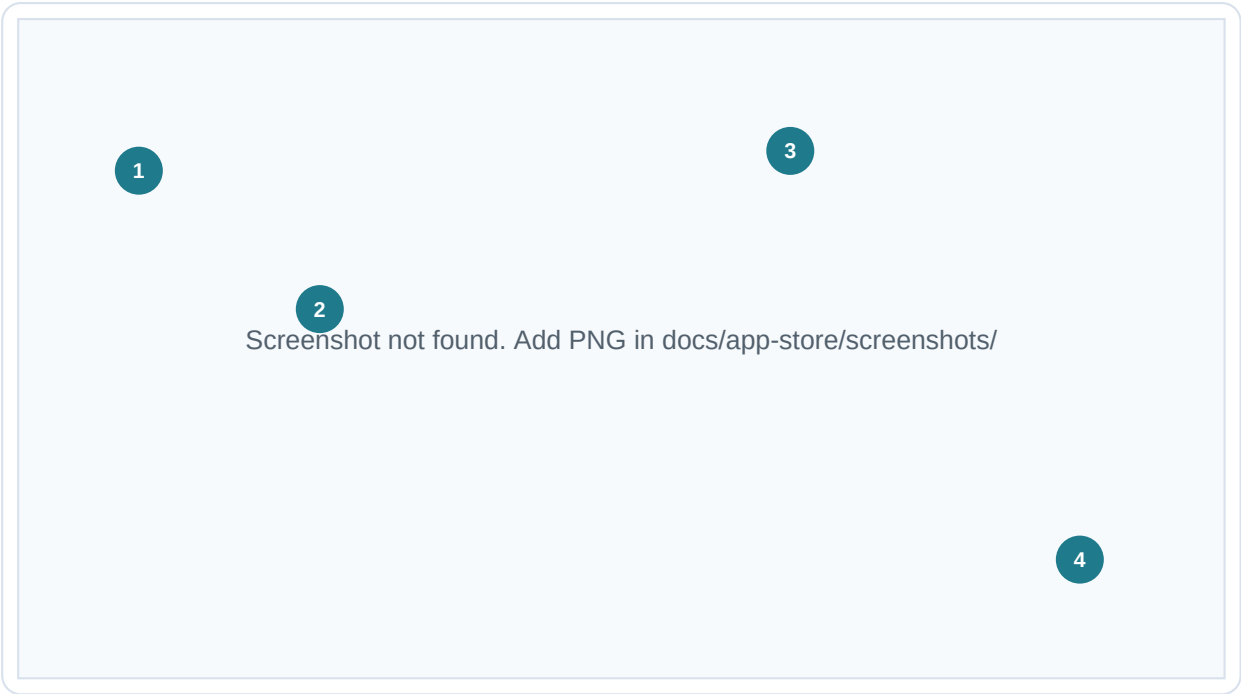
Surface Capability Snapshot

Current feature availability across the three app surfaces.

Capability	Main window	Menu bar	Hotkey launcher
First-run onboarding	Yes	No	No
View prompts	Yes	Yes	Yes
Search prompts	Yes	Yes	Yes
Create prompt	Yes	Yes	No
Edit prompt content	Yes	No	No
Parse `{{variables}}` in content	Yes	No	No
Fill template variable values	Yes	No	No
Preview resolved template output	Yes	No	No
Copy to clipboard	Yes	Yes	Yes
Copy resolved template output	Yes	Yes	Yes
Paste into front app	No	Yes	Yes
Favorite / unfavorite	Yes	Yes	No

Main Window Workflow

Library management and editing in the primary split-view workspace.



1	Sidebar filters: Switch between Recent, All Prompts, and Archived.
2	Prompt list: Browse prompts and open context actions.
3	Title + editor: Edit prompt title/content with autosave.
4	Inspector: Manage tags, favorite state, and archive status.

Expected screenshot file(s): 01-library-overview.png, 02-editor-detail.png, main-window.png, library-overview.png

Menu Bar Quick Access

Fast search and action controls from the popover surface.



1	Search: Filter prompts by title, content, or tags.
2	Filter tabs: Jump to Favorites, All, or Archived.
3	Expanded row: Copy, paste, favorite, archive, or delete.
4	Bottom bar: Create prompts, open main window, or open settings.

Expected screenshot file(s): 03-menu-bar-popover.png, menu-bar-popover.png, menu-bar.png

Hotkey Launcher

Keyboard-first selection and instant copy/paste actions from any app.



1	Search input: Start typing immediately after opening Cmd+Shift+P.
2	Ranked results: Use Up/Down or Cmd+1..9 shortcuts.
3	Action view: Choose Copy or Paste when default is Show options.
4	Favorite hints: Starred prompts stay prominent in launcher results.

Expected screenshot file(s): 04-global-launcher.png, 05-quick-paste.png, global-launcher.png, hotkey-launcher.png

User guide

Visual walkthrough placeholders

Use these placeholders until final UI screenshots are captured. The file names match the existing screenshot plan in docs/app-store/screenshot-capture.md.

Placeholder 1: main library overview

- **Future image path:** docs/app-store/screenshots/01-library-overview.png
- **Capture target:** Main window with sidebar filters, search, and a selected prompt in the detail pane.
- **What should be visible:** Recently Used / All Prompts / Archived filters, prompt list, editor area.

Placeholder 2: prompt detail editor

- **Future image path:** docs/app-store/screenshots/02-editor-detail.png
- **Capture target:** Prompt detail editor with realistic title/content and the inspector open.
- **What should be visible:** Inline editing, variables section (if prompt contains `{{variable}}`), tags/favorite/archive controls.

Placeholder 3: menu bar popover

- **Future image path:** docs/app-store/screenshots/03-menu-bar-popover.png
- **Capture target:** Menu bar mini library open with search/filter state.
- **What should be visible:** Favorites/All/Archived filter pills, prompt rows, quick actions.

Placeholder 4: global launcher

- **Future image path:** docs/app-store/screenshots/04-global-launcher.png
- **Capture target:** Hotkey launcher (Cmd+Shift+P) with query text and ranked results.
- **What should be visible:** Search field, highlighted selection, keyboard hint flow.

Placeholder 5: quick paste action

- **Future image path:** docs/app-store/screenshots/05-quick-paste.png
- **Capture target:** Action view after selecting a launcher result.
- **What should be visible:** Copy/Paste action buttons and selected prompt context.

Placeholder 6: favorites + archived state

- **Future image path:** docs/app-store/screenshots/06-favorites-archive.png
- **Capture target:** One view showing favorite and archived workflow states.
- **What should be visible:** A favorited prompt and archived-filter behavior.

Getting started

- Launch Paalt to open the main window (sidebar + detail editor).
- On first launch, a short onboarding flow introduces main window, menu bar, and hotkey launcher.
- Use **Cmd+N** (or the + button) to create a new prompt.

Create a prompt

- Main window: click **+** or press **Cmd+N** to create a new prompt.
- Menu bar popover: click **New** to open the creation sheet.
- In the menu bar sheet, at least one of title/content is required to enable **Create**.
- In the main window flow, empty drafts are allowed and save as you edit.

Edit a prompt

- Select a prompt from the sidebar.
- Edit the title or content directly in the editor.
- Updates are saved after a short debounce.

Template variables

- Add placeholders in content using `{{variable_name}}` (letters, numbers, underscore).
- When placeholders exist, a **Variables** section appears below the editor.
- Fill variable values to generate a live resolved preview.
- Use **Clear** in the Variables section to reset all filled values for that prompt.
- Copy/paste actions resolve filled variables; unfilled variables remain as `{{variable_name}}`.

Tags

- Open the inspector (info button or **Cmd+I**).
- Add existing tags or create new ones with a color.
- Click a tag pill in the sidebar list to filter by that tag.

Favorites and archive

- Toggle favorite from the context menu or inspector.
- Archive prompts to remove them from the default list.
- Use the **Archived** filter to view archived prompts.

Search and filters

- Use the search field in the sidebar to match title, content, or tag name.
- Filters include **Recently Used**, **All Prompts**, and **Archived**.

Menu bar access

- Click the menu bar icon to open the mini library.
- Use filters: **Favorites**, **All**, **Archived**.
- Search, expand a prompt, and use **Copy**, **Paste**, **Favorite**, **Archive**, or **Delete**.
- Create a new prompt from the popover.

Global hotkey launcher

- Press **Cmd+Shift+P** to open the launcher from anywhere.
- Type to search, then press **Return** to perform the configured default action.
- Use **Up/Down** to move selection.
- Use **Cmd+1..Cmd+9** to instantly run the top nine results.
- If default action is **Show options**, choose **Copy** or **Paste** in the action view.
- The default action is configurable in Preferences: **Show options** (default), **Copy to clipboard**, or **Paste to app**.

Copy and paste feedback

- A floating toast notification confirms when a prompt has been copied to the clipboard.
- Delete actions require confirmation before removing a prompt.
- Paste actions use Accessibility APIs. If needed, macOS prompts for permission on first paste attempt.

Preferences

- Open **Settings** from the menu bar popover or the app menu.
- **Launch at login** toggles automatic startup.
- **Show dock icon** switches between accessory and regular app modes.
- **Default action** controls what happens when you select a prompt in the launcher: show options, copy to clipboard, or paste into the frontmost app.
- **Paste delay** controls the delay (in milliseconds) before simulating Cmd+V after copying.

Tips

- Use short titles for faster scanning in the sidebar and launcher.
- Add tags for long-term organization and favorites for quick access.
- Empty state messages guide you when no prompts match your search or filter.

FAQ

Why don't I see archived prompts?

- Archived prompts are hidden from the default list. Switch to **Archived** in the sidebar.

Why doesn't the hotkey work?

- Ensure Pault is running. If paste actions fail, macOS will automatically prompt for Accessibility permission. Grant access in **System Settings > Privacy & Security > Accessibility**.

Why do I still see {{variable}} after copying?

- That variable currently has an empty value in the Variables section. Fill it to resolve on copy/paste.

Can I export or import prompts?

- Not yet. Export/import is planned but not implemented in the current app target.

Troubleshooting

Global hotkey does not open the launcher

- Confirm the app is running (menu bar icon visible or app in Dock).
- Hotkey is fixed to Cmd+Shift+P in the current build; check for conflicts with other apps.
- If it still fails, check Console for logs from the Pault process about hotkey registration failures.

Paste action does nothing

- Paste actions simulate Cmd+V using CGEvent and require Accessibility permission.
- Open **System Settings > Privacy & Security** and grant access to Pault.
- Ensure the target app is frontmost when you run the paste action.

Menu bar icon is missing

- If **Show dock icon** is disabled, the app runs as an accessory. Launch Pault directly once to restore the menu bar icon.
- If the icon still does not appear, quit and relaunch the app.

Prompts appear missing

- Check the **Archived** filter in the sidebar.
- Clear the search field to ensure prompts are not filtered out.

Changes are not saved between launches

- If SwiftData fails to load the persistent store, Pault falls back to an in-memory store.
- Look for messages like "SwiftData persistent store failed" in Console logs.
- If this happens, back up the container directory and reinstall or reset the app data.

Copied text still contains {{variable}}

- Unfilled template variables are intentionally left unresolved on copy/paste.
- Open the prompt in the main window and set values in the **Variables** section.